

DCD 110 01: Digital Storytelling for Web

Spring 2026

Coastal Carolina University

Class Meetings: T, Th 12:15 PM - 1:30 PM

Edwards Humanities & Fine Arts (EHFA), 106 (The Digital Commons)

Instructor: Dr. Gayas Eapen

Office Hours: W 11 am -1 pm, TTh 10-10:50 in EHFA 209, or by appointment

Catalog description: This course provides students with a critical foundation in telling digital stories through web-based languages HTML and CSS. The course focuses on providing students a foundation in how the web works, the information organization and logic of a web site, the ways HTML works to structure web pages, and the ways CSS works to style those pages. Students learn to write HTML and CSS, and design story-based web pages through local coding practices and processes, thinking carefully and expansively about how people access web-based information, and how to ensure that everyone, regardless of device, bandwidth, or ability, can access that information. Through hands-on, critical making practices, students gain important skills and knowledge in conceptualizing, testing, designing, writing, and coding web-based narrative.

Course description: This course will engage with the foundations of web-based storytelling. We will start with understanding file structures and web-based storage. We will then move on to manually crafting web-pages and hosting them. We will also learn to work with three primary web-based languages: HTML, CSS and JavaScript (JS) using short creative coding assignments. Students will work on conceptually and creatively imbibing the spirit of web-based creation for simple and personal stories. We will also be looking at a few examples of web-based storytelling that have utilized similar languages and pre-existing tools for storytelling. Finally, students will be introduced to a few ready-to-use tools that are frequently utilized for web-based storytelling across disciplinary areas. Throughout the course, we will also emphasize on conceptually grasping the architecture of the web, semantics of web-based languages, and the ability to creatively transform storytelling using programming as a system of inscription.

Course objectives:

- Have a working understanding of HTML, CSS, and basic JavaScript
- Have a grasp of design conventions and principles specific to the web and interactive media
- Grasp what it means to be a digital storyteller in the age of AI
- Appreciate the history and potential of web and web-based languages as storytelling tools

Homepages: Early in the semester we will set up individual Homepage websites to house all products of this class (projects, writing, anything else...). We will host them using a free service called Github Pages. You can design and organize your homepage however you like, as long as all content required in this class is accessible and easily found. You will turn projects in by publishing them to your Homepage.

This Homepage will later be developed into your personal web project based on a broad theme to create your website. This could be something simple like a website about your cat or one that documents your walks or your adventures, in the city or on Minecraft. As we move through new lessons in HTML and CSS, you will find ways to incorporate those lessons to advance your website. Since incorporating multimedia (pictures, videos, or interactive elements) elements will take some time, you will have to use your creative processes to write stuff out. Writing will be key, anyway, as the programming process also involves writing. Gradually you will work on adding links using the <a> tag in HTML and create an interconnected hypertext website.

Reflections

Each week we will do a little learning and each week you will do a little creation. Based on the lesson, you will add your reflection to your website. Sometimes you will read or watch a little, and then you will reflect a little on your Homepage. A few sentences are all that is required, but feel free to write and add however much you would like – it is your website after all.

If you would rather not write, feel free to respond in whatever way you would like. Maybe it's a drawing, a small webpage, a self-made meme, or something else!

For most readings, we will host a reading discussion the week after the reading is assigned. These readings will help

facilitate a common understanding about the internet's history and its potential as a tool to tell crafty and interesting stories. Hopefully, they will also serve as inspiration for us!

Digital Storytelling Works Presentation Each student will choose a work of electronic literature or digital storytelling they present orally to the class. You will identify one work from a list of options (will be available on Moodle) and put it on a spreadsheet (to reduce duplication).

Code walkthroughs after 3-6-9 weeks (dates on Moodle): You will both show your code and explain how you made what you made. This is significant since we are only interested (for the purposes of this course) in code you can explain and how it alters your webpage(s).

A small heads up/AI Policy: ChatGPT and similar tools are pretty easy to spot when they're being used. While our journal entries are a small part of our class, they're an important component for developing a personal voice and perspective for our practices. Additionally, the expectation for this course will be that you will learn to use code from the lessons we will collectively go over. If you do end up using borrowed code from elsewhere, you will need to know how to explain that code and what it is doing in your web-page. This will take place during the periodic "code walkthrough" sessions which are marked in the course calendar.

Class Collection The class collection is an are.na channel for collecting and sharing websites and relevant resources with the class. Engagement with the class collection is optional but strongly encouraged! Over time, this will become a shared resource of inspiration, reference, and information for our class, future digital storytelling classes, and for any wanderer who comes across the collection. The collection can be found [here](#). Please remember that this is a publicly available resource.

Grading In this class, I am interested in how you learn the foundations of web design and use it to artfully and creatively design your webpages. I am also interested in how you are reflecting on the materials and reading we will be engaging with in the classroom. All periodic tasks assigned in the class will be used to assess your participation, process, and execution which will be weighted based on the rubric below. You will be required to do presentations, reflect on readings, write code

and host your website, and develop it. Periodic prompts will be provided to help you with that.

Grading rubric:

40% – Participation

40% – Process

20% – Execution

Your midterm grades will be an indicator on how you started off the course. Around mid-March, I will upload another set of grades which will indicate your progress. After that, only final grades will be uploaded. If you need to check-in about your grade standing, please reach out to me.

Here's a breakdown in the contract grading model, which means I will grade you based on this, which will implicitly grade your work without making personal judgements about it. These are, however, just guidelines. I will try to be as accommodating as possible. If you have something major going on, please communicate with me and we will try to find a way forward.

A	- regularly engaging in discussions in the classroom and/or offering support to classmates - experimenting with and applying yourself to problems/ideas outside of what we cover in class - communicating with care and consideration - making steady progress with the design work and reflections
B	- fewer than 5 absences (with notice given) - occasionally engaging in discussions and/or offering support to classmates - engaging regularly with and building upon the content introduced in class
C/D	- 5 or more absences - missing or unthoughtful work - rarely engaging in discussions and/or supporting classmates
F	- 8 or more absences - a large amount of missing work - at this point, I will advise you to withdraw from the class to protect your academic record

Required Reading:

Maisa Imamović The Psychology of a Web Developer: Reality of a Female Freelancer

You can download the book here: <https://networkcultures.org/wp-content/uploads/2022/09/ThePsychologyOfaWebDeveloper.pdf>

Or buy a copy [here](#)

Prying: Jhave on Tender Claws' New App:

<https://lareviewofbooks.org/article/prying-jhave-on-tender-claws-new-app/>

Pieces to view (more may be added to course Moodle)

1. A Modern Moral Fairy Tale

<http://www.deenalarsen.net/mmf/index.html>

2. At Nightfall, The Goldfish (Melody Mou)

<https://thenewriver.us/wp-content/uploads/2021/Spring%202021%20Full%20Piece%20Uploads/Mou-2/AtNightfalltheGoldfish-main%202/Goldfish.html>

3. Pry-the App by Tender Claws (need to pay \$2.99 to access on iOS Appstore)

A List of other critical resources will be shared on course Moodle page

Materials

- All students will need access to a laptop or a computer to complete this course. There are fairly advanced PCs located in the digital commons (Edwards 106) where the class will be held. Please utilize those computers. There is also an HDMI cable to connect your laptops to the screen. While working in the class, it is recommended that you connect your computers to those screens, so I or a peer can offer suggestions to your code/design and troubleshoot with you.
- A text editor like VS Code or Brackets
- A reliable browser: Mozilla is recommended, but Google Chrome or Safari will also work
- A GitHub Account: Can be created for free using Github.com; use a non-institutional email for longevity.
- A sketchbook: For off screen thinking, note-taking, journaling

Attendance/Participation

Students are expected to attend all class sessions and on time. I will be strictly following the university's guidelines on attendance. If you miss more than seven class sessions in total during the course, you will automatically receive an 'F' grade unless they are all exempted by the exemptions outlined in the university's attendance policy found [here](#). I will give three unexcused absences—which means you don't need to give me any proof for being excused; you will however need to inform me that you have been or will be absent from class. Any other absences will need to be excused and will require proof.

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